“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 4

The Inner Reasons for Śrī Caitanya's Advent

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

1 By the mercy of Śrī Caitanya, even a child who has studied the scriptures can ascertain the true form of Him who enjoys pastimes in Vraja.

2 All glory, all glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaita-candra, and glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

3 I have explained the meaning of the fourth verse. Now hear attentively the meaning of the fifth.

4 Before disclosing the meaning of the original verse and applying it, I shall first give a hint of it.

5 This I have shown to be the essence of the fourth verse: the Lord descended in this form to spread love for Kṛṣṇa and His Holy Name.

6 This reason is true, but it is external. Hear: there is another reason, an internal one.

7 The scriptures proclaim that in the past Kṛṣṇa descended to remove the burden of the earth.

8 Yet removing that burden is not the work of the Supreme Lord Himself (*svayaṁ bhagavān*). Viṣṇu, the maintainer, protects the world.

9 But the time for removing the burden coincided with the time of Kṛṣṇa's descent.

10 When the complete Bhagavān descends, all the other avatāras come and join in Him.

11–12 Nārāyaṇa, the four *vyūhas*, Matsya and the other avatāras, the avatāras of the yugas and of the manvantaras, and all others there are — all come and descend within the body of Kṛṣṇa. In this way Kṛṣṇa, the complete Bhagavān, descends.

13 Therefore Viṣṇu was then present within Kṛṣṇa's body, and it was through Viṣṇu that Kṛṣṇa slew the demons.

14 This killing of demons is a secondary task. Now I shall tell the root cause for which He descended.

15–16 Kṛṣṇa, the crown of all relishers of *rasa*, is supremely merciful. His desire to descend arose from two reasons: to taste the very essence of the *rasa* of love, and to spread in the world devotion on the path of spontaneous love (*rāga-mārga*).

17 “The whole world is mixed with awareness of My majesty, and love weakened by that majesty gives Me no pleasure.

18 If someone regards Me as the Lord and himself as lowly, I am not controlled by his love and do not become subservient to him.

19 In whatever mood any devotee worships Me, in that very mood I reciprocate with him. Such is My nature.

20 “As people surrender to Me, so I reciprocate with them. O son of Pṛthā, people follow My path in every way.” (Bhagavad-gītā 4.11)

21–22 When someone serves Me with pure devotion thinking, ‘He is my son,’ ‘He is my friend,’ ‘He is the lord of my life,’ and regards himself as great and Me as his equal or even lower, then in that mood I become subservient to him.

23 “Devotion to Me brings living beings to immortality. How fortunate you are that you have come to love Me, for that love brings you to Me!” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.82.44)

24 My mother binds Me, seeing Me as her son. Thinking Me utterly helpless, she fondles Me and cares for Me.

25 My friend, in pure friendship, climbs onto My shoulders and says, ‘What sort of big man are You? You and I are equal!’

26 And when My beloved, in a mood of jealous anger (*māna*), rebukes Me, that captivates My heart more than the hymns of the Vedas.

27–28 Bringing this pure devotion with Me, I shall descend and perform wonderful pastimes of many kinds. I shall perform pastimes never manifest in Vaikuṇṭha or anywhere else — pastimes that fill even Me with wonder.

29 By her own power Yogamāyā will make the gopīs regard Me as their paramour (*upapati*).

30 Neither I nor the gopīs will know this, for the beauty and qualities of each will always captivate the mind of the other.

31 Setting aside religious norms, the two will unite out of loving attachment (*rāga*). Sometimes they will meet and sometimes not, as destiny arranges.

32 I shall taste the very essence of all these *rasas*, and in this way I shall bestow mercy on all devotees.

33 Hearing of the pure love of Vraja, the devotees will worship Me on the path of spontaneous love, giving up religious duties and rites."

34 "To show mercy to His devotees, He assumes a humanlike form and performs such pastimes that whoever hears of them must become wholly devoted to Him." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.33.36)

35 The verb *bhavet*, "must become," is in the injunctive mood (*vidhi-liṅ*). It declares this a binding duty; to neglect it is a fault.

36–37 Just as this desire was the cause of Kṛṣṇa's appearance, while slaying the demons was a secondary purpose, so too Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa is the complete Bhagavān, and establishing the religion of the age is not what He Himself desires.

38 When, for His own reason, He resolved to descend, the time for the religion of the age coincided with it.

39 For these two reasons He descended with His devotees, and Himself relished love and the congregational chanting of the Name.

40 In this way He spread *kīrtana* even to the outcastes (*caṇḍālas*). Weaving a garland of the Name and of love, He placed it around the neck of the whole world.

41 Thus, accepting the mood of a devotee, He preached devotion by practising it Himself.

42 Servitude, friendship, parental love and amorous love are the four kinds of love, and the four kinds of devotees are their vessels.

43 Each of them considers his own mood the best, and in that mood relishes happiness with Kṛṣṇa.

44 Yet if we consider the matter impartially in our hearts, amorous love holds greater sweetness than all the other *rasas*.

45 “Although this love (*rati*) holds ever greater delight of taste in each higher *rasa*, any one of them appears sweetest to a particular devotee according to his own inclination.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu 2.5.38)

46 Therefore I call it *madhura-rasa*, the sweet *rasa*. It takes two forms: *svakīyā*, love as one's own wife, and *parakīyā*, love as another's.

47 In the *parakīyā* mood *rasa* rises to its greatest exultation, and it dwells nowhere but in Vraja.

48 In the young women of Vraja this love is boundless, and among them Śrī Rādhā's love is its very pinnacle.

49 Her mature and pure love is the highest of all; through it Kṛṣṇa's sweetness is tasted.

50 Therefore Śrī Hari, appearing as Gaurāṅga, accepted that mood and fulfilled His own desire.

51 “He is the fortress of the lords of the gods, the supreme goal of the Upaniṣads, the all-in-all of the sages, the sweetness of the hosts who bow to Him, and the very essence of the love of all the lotus-eyed cowherd maidens. Will that Caitanya ever again come within the range of my eyes?” (Stava-mālā, First Caitanyāṣṭaka 2)

52 “Playful by nature, He wished to take for Himself and enjoy the boundless, indescribably sweet wealth of *rasa* belonging to one among

the host of His loving ones. So He covered His own complexion and revealed here Her radiance. May that Lord, who has appeared in the form of Caitanya, be abundantly merciful to us." (Stava-mālā, Second Caitanyāṣṭaka 3)

53 He established religion for the sake of accepting that mood. Now hear, everyone, as I tell the chief reason for this.

54 Earlier I gave a hint of the verse that tells the root cause. Now I shall disclose the meaning of that verse.

55 "Rādhā is the transformation of love for Kṛṣṇa; She is His pleasure-giving potency (*hlādinī śakti*). Therefore, although Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are one in soul, long ago They assumed separate forms on earth. Now the two have become one and appeared as Caitanya. I bow to Him, who is Kṛṣṇa Himself, adorned with Rādhā's emotion and radiance." (Svarūpa Dāmodara's diary)

56 Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are one soul. Assuming two bodies, They sport with each other and relish *rasa*.

57 Now those two are one as Lord Caitanya: to relish that love, both have come together in one form.

58 For this reason I shall first describe this truth, for from it the glory of Gaura will be told.

59 Rādhikā is the transformation of love for Kṛṣṇa. She is His very own potency (*svarūpa-śakti*), whose name is *hlādinī*.

60 *Hlādinī* makes Kṛṣṇa taste bliss, and through *hlādinī* He nourishes His devotees.

61 Kṛṣṇa's own form is eternity, knowledge and bliss, and it is complete. His one spiritual potency takes three forms.

62 In its aspect of bliss it is *hlādinī*, in its aspect of existence *sandhinī*, and in its aspect of consciousness *saṁvit*, which we know as knowledge.

63 "*Hlādinī*, *sandhinī* and *saṁvit* exist in You as one, O basis of all. But the mixed potency that brings both joy and pain is not in You, for You are free from the material qualities (*guṇas*)." (Viṣṇu Purāṇa 1.12.69)

64 The essence of *sandhinī* is called *śuddha-sattva*, pure being. In it the existence of Bhagavān rests.

65 Kṛṣṇa's mother and father, His abode, His house, His bed, His seat and all the rest are transformations of His *śuddha-sattva*.

66 "Pure being (*viśuddha-sattva*) is called *vasudeva*, because in it the Supreme Person is revealed without any covering. In that pure being I worship with my mind Bhagavān Vāsudeva, who is beyond the reach of the senses (*adhokṣaja*)." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 4.3.23)

67 Knowledge of Kṛṣṇa as Bhagavān is the essence of *saṁvit*. Knowledge of Brahman and all other knowledge form its retinue.

68 The essence of *hlādinī* is love (*prema*); the essence of *prema* is *bhāva*; and the highest limit of *bhāva* is called *mahābhāva*.

69 Śrī Rādhā Ṭhākurāṇī is *mahābhāva* embodied. She is the mine of all virtues and the crown jewel of Kṛṣṇa's beloveds.

70 "Of these two chief gopīs, Rādhikā is superior in every way. She is *mahābhāva* embodied and surpasses all in virtues." (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi 4.3)

71 Her mind, senses and body are steeped in love for Kṛṣṇa. Rādhā is Kṛṣṇa's own potency and His companion in His pastimes.

72 “I worship Govinda, the original Person. Though He is the soul of all, He dwells in Goloka itself with them — His potencies (*kalā*), who are His own form and are imbued with the *rasa* of spiritual bliss.” (Brahma-saṁhitā 5.37)

73 Hear now how She makes Kṛṣṇa relish *rasa* and how She assists in His pastimes.

74–75 We see Kṛṣṇa's beloveds as being of three kinds: the goddesses of fortune (Lakṣmīs), the queens in the city, and the women of Vraja, who are the very essence of all His beloveds. All the beloveds expand from Śrī Rādhikā.

76 Just as Kṛṣṇa, the source of all avatāras, manifests avatāras, so the three groups expand from Rādhā, the source of all portions.

77 Her *vaibhava* expansions are, as it were, the splendor of Her body, and the host of queens are like reflections of Her image.

78 The Lakṣmīs are Her portions in the form of *vaibhava-vilāsa*, and the queens are Her *vaibhava-prakāśa*.

79 The goddesses of Vraja, differing in appearance and nature, are expansions of Her own body (*kāya-vyūha*), and they exist for the sake of *rasa*.

80 Without many beloveds *rasa* cannot reach its full exultation. Therefore She has many manifestations to assist in the pastimes.

81 Among them, in Vraja, through their many varieties of mood and *rasa*, they make Kṛṣṇa relish the *rāsa* dance and His other pastimes.

82 Rādhā delights Govinda and enchants Govinda. She is Govinda's all-in-all and the crown jewel of all His beloveds.

83 “The goddess Rādhikā is called full of Kṛṣṇa (*kṛṣṇa-mayī*) and the supreme Goddess. She contains all the Lakṣmīs, She possesses all splendor (*sarva-kānti*), and She is the supreme enchantress.” (Bṛhad-gautamīya-tantra)

84 *Devī* means “shining and supremely beautiful,” or else “the city where Kṛṣṇa is worshipped and where He plays.”

85 *Kṛṣṇa-mayī* means that Kṛṣṇa is within Her and without. Wherever Her eyes fall, there Kṛṣṇa appears.

86 Or else: Kṛṣṇa's own form is full of the *rasa* of love, and His potency is one with Him.

87 Her worship consists in fulfilling Kṛṣṇa's desires. Therefore the Purāṇas explain Her name as Rādhikā, “She who worships.”

88 “Surely it is by Her that the Lord, Bhagavān Hari, has been worshipped, since Govinda, pleased with Her, has left us behind and led Her to a secluded place.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.30.28)

89 Therefore She is worshipable by all and is the supreme Goddess. She protects all and is the mother of the whole universe.

90 I have already explained the word *sarva-lakṣmī*: She is the source and abode of all the Lakṣmīs.

91 Or else, *sarva-lakṣmī* means Kṛṣṇa's six kinds of opulence, and She is the potency that presides over them, the best of all potencies.

92 *Sarva-kānti* means that in Her dwells the splendor of all beauty, and from Her comes the beauty of all the Lakṣmīs.

93 Or else, the word *kānti* means all of Kṛṣṇa's desires: all of Kṛṣṇa's desires rest in Rādhā alone.

94 Rādhikā fulfills whatever Kṛṣṇa desires. This is the meaning of the word *sarva-kānti*.

95 Kṛṣṇa enchants the world, and She enchants Him. Therefore She is the supreme Mistress of all.

96 Rādhā is the complete potency, and Kṛṣṇa is the complete possessor of potency. The scriptures testify that there is no difference between the two.

97 They are as inseparable as musk and its fragrance, as fire and its heat, which are never different.

98 In the same way Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are always one in nature, but They assume two forms to relish the *rasa* of Their pastimes.

99–100 To teach loving devotion (*prema-bhakti*), Kṛṣṇa Himself descended. Accepting both Rādhā's emotion and Her radiance, He appeared in the form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. This is the explanation of the fifth verse.

101 To disclose the meaning of the sixth verse, I shall first give a hint of it.

102 The Lord descended and spread the congregational chanting of the Name. As I indicated before, this too is an external reason.

103 There is another, principal seed of His descent. It is the personal concern of Kṛṣṇa, the crown of all relishers of *rasa*.

104 That most hidden reason has three aspects. It became known through Svarūpa Dāmodara.

105 Svarūpa Gosvāmī is the Lord's most intimate associate, and therefore he knows these matters of the Lord.

106 The Lord's heart is the very image of Rādhikā's emotion. In that mood joy and sorrow arise in Him constantly.

107 In His final pastimes the Lord was in the divine madness of separation from Kṛṣṇa. His actions were full of bewilderment, and His words were delirious.

108 Day and night the Lord remained intoxicated with the emotion Rādhikā felt on seeing Uddhava.

109 At night, holding Svarūpa by the neck, He would speak deliriously, and in His absorption He laid bare the emotions of His heart.

110 Whenever an emotion arose in the Lord's heart, Dāmodara would gladden Him with a song or verse suited to it.

111 There is no need to examine all this now. Later I shall describe it in detail.

112 Formerly, in Vraja, Kṛṣṇa passed through three ages: infancy (*kaumāra*), boyhood (*paugaṇḍa*) and youth (*kaiśora*), which is the most essential.

113 He made His infancy fruitful through absorption in parental love, and He made His boyhood fruitful with His friends.

114 With Rādhikā and the other gopīs He enjoyed the *rāsa* dance and other pastimes, and to His heart's content He tasted the essence of *rasa*.

115 His youth, Kāmadeva and the whole world — these three He made fruitful through the *rāsa* dance and His other pastimes.

116 "Honoring His youth, Madhusūdana, who destroys all misfortune, enjoyed at night amid a host of jewels among women." (Viṣṇu Purāṇa 5.13.59)

117 "Before Her friends He made Rādhikā close Her eyes in shyness with words that hinted at Her boldness in the arts of love the night before. He reached the summit of skill in drawing playful *makarīs* on Her breasts. Thus, enjoying pastimes in the groves, Hari makes His youth fruitful." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu 2.1.119)

118 "O lovely-eyed one, if this Hari had not descended in Mathurā, and Rādhikā with Him, this whole creation would have been in vain — and Kāmadeva most of all." (Vidagdha-mādhava 7.3)

119–120 In this way Kṛṣṇa, the abode of *rasa*, formerly relished the very essence of *rasa*. Yet though He tried to taste them, three of His desires remained unfulfilled.

121 Now I shall explain His first desire. Kṛṣṇa says: "I am the source of all *rasa*.

122 I am full of complete bliss, the complete spiritual truth, yet Rādhikā's love drives Me mad.

123 I do not know how much strength there is in Rādhā's love, by which She always overwhelms Me.

124 Rādhikā is My teacher in love, and I am Her pupil, a dancer. She always makes Me dance in many new and unheard-of ways.

125 "'Vṛndā, dear friend, where are you coming from?' 'From Hari's feet.' 'Where is He?' 'In the forest by Rādhā-kuṇḍa.' 'What is He doing there?' 'Learning to dance.' 'And who is His teacher?' 'Your own form, appearing in every tree and creeper in all directions. Like a skilled dancer it moves all around, making Him dance behind it.'" (Govinda-līlāmṛta 8.77)

126 Rādhā's relish of Her love is ten million times greater than the delight I feel in tasting My own love.

127 Just as I am the abode of mutually contradictory qualities, so Rādhā's love is always full of contradictions.

128 Rādhā's love is all-pervading; there is no room for it to grow. Yet it keeps growing at every moment.

129 Certainly there is nothing greater than it, yet it is free of the self-importance that marks the great.

130 There is nothing as pure as it, yet it is always contrary and its ways are crooked.

131 "All glory to Rādhikā's love for the enemy of Mura! Though all-pervading, it ever increases; though great, it is free of all self-importance; though its crookedness constantly grows, it is pure." (Dāna-keli-kaumudī 2)

132 Rādhikā is the supreme abode (*āśraya*) of that love, and I am only its object (*viṣaya*).

133 I taste the happiness that belongs to the object of love, but the delight of its abode is ten million times greater than Mine.

134 My mind runs after the happiness that belongs to the abode of love, but for all My effort I cannot taste it. What means can I find?

135 If ever I become the abode of this love, then I shall experience the bliss of this love."

136 Thinking thus, Kṛṣṇa, ever eager for play, remains with a longing for that love blazing ever higher in His heart.

137 That is one desire. Now hear of another kind of longing. Seeing His own sweetness, Kṛṣṇa reflects:

138 "My sweetness is wondrous, infinite and complete. No one in the three worlds can find its limit.

139 Through Her love Rādhikā alone eternally tastes the whole nectar of My sweetness.

140 Although the mirror of Rādhā's true love is spotless, its clarity grows at every moment.

141 My sweetness has no room to grow, yet before this mirror it shines in ever new forms.

142 My sweetness and Rādhā's love vie with each other. Both grow at every moment, and neither ever loses.

143 My sweetness is eternally new and fresh, and each devotee tastes it in keeping with his own love.

144 When I see My own sweetness in a mirror or elsewhere, I long to taste it, but I cannot.

145 And when I consider how I might taste it, My mind runs after becoming Rādhikā Herself.

146 “What is this wonder-working flood of My sweetness, never experienced before and greater than all, that now shines before Me? Seeing it, alas, even I grow greedy at heart, and like Rādhikā I long to enjoy it eagerly.” (Lalita-mādhava 8.34)

147 Kṛṣṇa's sweetness has a natural power: it stirs all men and women, and Kṛṣṇa Himself first among them.

148 Whether heard of or seen, it attracts every mind, and Kṛṣṇa Himself strives to taste it.

149 Whoever drinks this nectar of sweetness constantly never quenches his thirst: the thirst only grows without end.

150 Unsatisfied, he blames Brahmā, the Creator: “The Creator is unskilled; he does not know how to create well.

151 He did not give me ten million eyes; he gave me only two, and even these blink. How shall I see Kṛṣṇa?”

152 “The gopīs, who curse the maker of eyelids whenever they gaze at Him, at last obtained Kṛṣṇa, whom they had long desired. Taking Him into their hearts through their eyes, they all embraced Him to their fill and attained an ecstasy that is hard to attain even for those ever united with Him.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.82.39)

153 “When You wander in the forest by day, a moment becomes a *yuga* for us who cannot see You. And when we gaze at Your beautiful face framed by curling locks, the maker of our eyelids seems a fool.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.31.15)

154 The eyes have no fruit but seeing Kṛṣṇa. Whoever sees Kṛṣṇa is truly fortunate.

155 “Friends, for those who have eyes we know no fruit higher than this: to drink in the faces of the two sons of the lord of Vraja, graced by the flute and casting loving glances, as They lead the cows into the forest with Their companions.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.21.7)

156 “What austerities did the gopīs perform? With their eyes they drink in His form — the essence of loveliness, unequalled and unsurpassed, perfect in itself, new at every moment, hard to attain, the one abode of fame, beauty and majesty.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.44.14)

157 Kṛṣṇa's sweetness is unprecedented, and unprecedented is its power: merely hearing of it shakes the mind.

158 Kṛṣṇa's sweetness awakens longing in Kṛṣṇa Himself. Unable to taste it fully, He remains distressed at heart.

159 Thus I have described the second reason. Now hear the features of the third.

160 This conclusion about *rasa* is most deeply hidden. Only Svarūpa Dāmodara knows it fully.

161 Anyone else who knows it has learned it from him, for he is the very heart of Lord Caitanya.

162 The love of the gopīs is called *rūḍha-bhāva*. It is pure, spotless love and never *kāma*, selfish desire.

163 “The pure love of the cowherd women became known by the name *kāma*. Therefore even Uddhava and others dear to the Lord long for it.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu 1.2.285)

164 Lust and love have different characteristics, as different in nature as iron and gold.

165 The desire to please one's own senses I call *kāma*, lust; the wish to please Kṛṣṇa's senses bears the name *prema*, love.

166 The aim of lust is one's own enjoyment alone, but love, whose only aim is Kṛṣṇa's happiness, is mighty indeed.

167–169 Social custom, Vedic duty, the needs of the body and their work; shame, composure, bodily comfort and the very core of their own happiness; the path of noble conduct (*ārya-patha*), so hard to give up; their own relatives, and the punishments and rebukes of their kin — giving up all this, the gopīs worship Kṛṣṇa and serve Him with love for His happiness alone.

170 This is called firm attachment (*anurāga*) to Kṛṣṇa. It is like clean, freshly washed cloth without a single stain.

171 Therefore there is a vast difference between lust and love. Lust is blind darkness; love is the spotless sun.

172 Therefore the gopīs have not a trace of lust. Their only aim is Kṛṣṇa's happiness, and their only relationship is with Kṛṣṇa.

173 “O dear one, Your lotus feet are so tender that we place them gently on our hard breasts, fearing to hurt them. With those feet You roam the forest. Are they not pained by the sharp pebbles? Our minds reel at the thought, for You are our very life.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.31.19)

174 The gopīs give no thought to their own happiness or sorrow. All they do is for Kṛṣṇa's happiness.

175 For Kṛṣṇa's sake they have given up everything else, and their pure attachment seeks only His happiness.

176 “O gentle girls, for My sake you have cast off the opinion of the world, the injunctions of the Vedas and your own relatives. I hid Myself only to increase your attachment to Me, and even then I was loving you unseen. So, My dear ones, do not find fault with Me, your beloved.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.32.21)

177 Kṛṣṇa has a promise, made long ago: as one worships Him, so Kṛṣṇa reciprocates with him.

178 “As people surrender to Me, so I reciprocate with them. All people follow My path in every way, O Pārtha.” (Bhagavad-gītā 4.11)

179 That promise was broken by the gopīs' worship. The proof is in the words from Kṛṣṇa's own lips:

180 “Even in a lifetime of the gods I could not repay you, whose union with Me is flawless. You have worshiped Me, cutting the chains of home that are so hard to break. So let your own goodness be your reward.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.32.22)

181 If we sometimes see the gopīs caring for their own bodies, know for certain that this too is for Kṛṣṇa's sake.

182 “I have offered this body to Kṛṣṇa. It is His property, and it is for His enjoyment.

183 Seeing and touching this body delights Kṛṣṇa.” For this reason they cleanse and adorn their bodies.

184 “O Pārtha, the gopīs tend even their own bodies, thinking them Mine. For Me there is no vessel of hidden love higher than they.” (Ādi Purāṇa)

185 The gopīs' love has another wondrous trait, whose power lies beyond the reach of the intellect.

186 When the gopīs see Kṛṣṇa, they have no desire for their own happiness, yet their happiness becomes ten million times greater.

187 The gopīs taste a joy ten million times greater than the joy Kṛṣṇa feels on seeing them.

188 They have no regard for their own happiness, and yet their happiness grows. Here a contradiction arises.

189 I see only one solution to this contradiction: the gopīs' happiness culminates in Kṛṣṇa's happiness.

190 On seeing the gopīs, Kṛṣṇa's delight grows, and with it grows His sweetness, which has no equal.

191 “Seeing me, Kṛṣṇa has found such happiness!” In this joy the gopīs' faces and bodies blossom.

192 As much as Kṛṣṇa's beauty grows on seeing the beauty of the gopīs, so much does the gopīs' beauty grow on seeing Kṛṣṇa's.

193 In this way a contest arises between them. Each makes the other grow, and neither side turns away.

194 But Kṛṣṇa's happiness comes from the beauty and qualities of the gopīs, and His happiness makes the gopīs' happiness grow.

195 Therefore their happiness nourishes Kṛṣṇa's happiness, and for this reason the gopīs' love has no fault of lust.

196 "I worship Keśava as He returns in triumph from the forest to Vraja. On the road crowds of the beautiful young women of Vraja come to meet Him and worship Him with hundreds of dancing sidelong glances mingled with budding smiles, while the corners of His eyes, like bees, rove over the flower-buds of their breasts." (Stava-mālā, Keśavāṣṭaka 8)

197 Hear another natural sign of the gopīs' love, which shows how that love is without a trace of lust.

198 The gopīs' love nourishes Kṛṣṇa's sweetness, and that sweetness in turn increases their love and fills them with great satisfaction.

199 The bliss of the abode of love lies in the bliss of its object. There the desire for one's own happiness has no place.

200 Wherever love is unconditional, this is its rule: the abode of love finds joy in the happiness of its object.

201 If the bliss of his own love hinders the bliss of serving Kṛṣṇa, the devotee becomes very angry with that bliss.

202 "Dāruka did not welcome the bliss of love that made his limbs grow stiff, for it was a great hindrance to his fanning Kṛṣṇa, the enemy of Kaṁsa." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu 3.2.62)

203 “The lotus-eyed Rādhā loudly condemned the bliss that showered floods of tears and kept Her from seeing Govinda.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu 2.3.54)

204 Moreover, pure devotees will not accept *sālokya* or any other kind of liberation for their own happiness if it means being without loving service to Kṛṣṇa.

205 “Simply on hearing of My qualities, the mind flows unbroken toward Me, who dwell in every heart, as the waters of the Ganges flow into the ocean.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 3.29.11)

206 “Such devotion to the Supreme Person, causeless and uninterrupted, is declared to be the mark of transcendent *bhakti-yoga*.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 3.29.12)

207 “Even when I offer them *sālokya*, *sārṣṭi*, *sāmīpya*, *sārūpya* or even oneness with Me, My devotees will not accept it if it means being without service to Me.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 3.29.13)

208 “Fulfilled by serving Me, My devotees do not desire even the four kinds of liberation, beginning with *sālokya*, though these come to them through serving Me. How then could they want anything else, which time destroys?” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 9.4.67)

209 The gopīs' natural love is without a trace of lust. It is spotless, radiant and pure, like gold refined in fire.

210 The gopīs are Kṛṣṇa's helpers, teachers, friends and beloveds, His dear disciples, confidantes and maidservants.

211 “O Pārtha, I tell you the truth: the gopīs are My helpers, teachers, disciples, maidservants, friends and wives. What are they not to Me?”

(Gopī-premāmṛta)

212 The gopīs know the desires of Kṛṣṇa's heart, the perfect art of loving service, and every wish of their beloved.

213 “O Pārtha, the gopīs know My greatness, how to worship Me, how to revere Me, and what is in My mind. No one else knows these in truth.” (Ādi Purāṇa)

214 Among those gopīs Rādhikā is the best. In beauty, qualities, good fortune and love She surpasses all.

215 “As Rādhā is dear to Viṣṇu (Kṛṣṇa), so is Her pond dear to Him. Among all the gopīs She alone is His most beloved.” (Padma Purāṇa)

216 “O Pārtha, in the three worlds the earth is blessed, for there lies the town of Vṛndāvana. There the gopīs are blessed, and among them My beloved named Rādhā.” (Ādi Purāṇa)

217 All the other gopīs are instruments of *rasa*: they serve to increase the *rasa* of Kṛṣṇa's play with Rādhā.

218 Rādhā is Kṛṣṇa's beloved, the treasure of His life. Without Her the gopīs cannot make Him happy.

219 “Kṛṣṇa, the enemy of Kaṁsa, placed Rādhā in His heart — She was the chain that bound His desire for the very essence of the *rāsa* dance — and left the other beauties of Vraja.” (Gīta-govinda 3.1)

220 Taking that mood of Rādhā, Kṛṣṇa descended as Caitanya and spread the dharma of the age — the Holy Name — and love for Kṛṣṇa.

221 In that mood He fulfilled His own desires. This desire is the root cause of His descent.

222 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the son of the king of Vraja. Kṛṣṇa, whose form is made of *rasa*, is *śṛṅgāra*, the amorous *rasa*, in person.

223 He descended to taste that *rasa*, and along the way He spread all the *rasas*.

224 “O friend, see Hari, charmed, playing in springtime like *śṛṅgāra* embodied! Delighting all, He creates bliss; with limbs as dark and soft as a row of blue lotuses He brings a festival to Kāmadeva; and the beauties of Vraja freely embrace Him on all sides, limb by limb.” (Gīta-govinda 1.11)

225 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the abode of *rasa*. He tasted *rasa* in endless variety.

226 In this way He established the dharma of the age of Kali. The servants of Śrī Caitanya know the heart of all this.

227–228 Advaita Ācārya, Nityānanda, Śrīvāsa, Gadādhara, Dāmodara, Murāri, Haridāsa and all the other devotees of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya — with devotion I place the feet of all of them on my head.

229 Thus I have given a hint of the sixth verse. Now hear the meaning of the verse itself as I disclose it.

230 “How great is Śrī Rādhā's love? What is My own wondrous sweetness, which She alone relishes through that love? And what happiness does She feel when She realizes Me?” Longing to know this, the moon Hari, rich with Her emotion, was born from the ocean of Śacī's womb.

231 All these conclusions are hidden; it is not fitting to speak of them. Yet if I do not speak of them, no one will ever reach their depth.

232 Therefore I shall say something of them, keeping it veiled. Devotees who relish *rasa* will understand; fools will not.

233 Whoever holds Caitanya and Nityānanda in his heart will find bliss in all these conclusions.

234 All these conclusions are like tender mango shoots, ever dear to the cuckoos who are the devotees.

235 The camels who are non-devotees cannot enter here, and this gives my heart special joy.

236 If those for fear of whom I hesitate to speak do not understand, what greater happiness could there be in the three worlds?

237 Therefore, bowing to the devotees, I speak without fear. Let them be filled with wonder.

238 Kṛṣṇa had one thought within His heart: “They call Me the very form of complete bliss and *rasa*.

239 The three worlds take delight in Me. But who is there who could give delight to Me?

240 Only one whose qualities are hundreds of times greater than Mine could delight My mind.

241 In this world no one can have greater qualities than Mine. Yet in Rādhā alone I sense such qualities.

242–243 My beauty surpasses that of ten million Kāmadevas; My sweetness has no equal or superior, and My beauty refreshes the three worlds. Yet it is the sight of Rādhā that soothes My eyes.

244 The song of My flute attracts the three worlds, but Rādhā's words captivate My ears.

245 Although My fragrance makes the whole world fragrant, the fragrance of Rādhā's body captivates My heart and My sense of smell.

246 Although My *rasa* makes the world sweet, Rādhā subdues Me with the nectar of Her lips.

247 Although My touch is cooler than ten million moons, Rādhikā's touch cools and refreshes Me.

248 Thus I am the cause of the world's happiness, but Rādhikā's beauty and qualities are My very life.

249 This is how I experience it. Yet when I consider it closely, I see it is all the other way round.

250 Seeing Rādhā soothes My eyes, but on seeing Me, Rādhā loses consciousness in happiness.

251 The sound of bamboos rubbing together steals Her consciousness, for She takes it for My flute; and mistaking a *tamāla* tree for Me, She embraces it.

252 “I have Kṛṣṇa's embrace — my life has borne fruit!” Holding the tree in Her arms, She remains immersed in this happiness.

253 If a favorable breeze brings Her My fragrance, She longs to fly to Me, blinded by love.

254 When She tastes betel I have chewed, She drowns in an ocean of bliss and knows nothing else.

255 Even if I spoke with a hundred mouths, I could not reach the end of the bliss Rādhā finds in My company.

256 When Our pastimes are over, Her body is sweet with happiness, and seeing it, I forget Myself in joy.

257 Bharata Muni holds that both lovers share equally in *rasa*, but he does not know the *rasa* of My Vraja.

258 In Rādhā's company I find a hundred times more happiness than in union with anyone else.

259 “O lovely Rādhā, Your bimba-red lips surpass the sweetness and fragrance of nectar. Your face has the fragrance of the lotus. Your words outdo the much-praised song of the cuckoo. Your limbs are cool as sandal, and this body of Yours holds all the wealth of beauty. Attaining You, all My senses rejoice again and again.” (Lalita-mādhava 9.9)

260 “Her eyes are greedy for the beauty of Kṛṣṇa, the slayer of Kaṁsa; Her skin thrills at His touch; Her ears long for His words; Her nostrils delight in His fragrance; Her tongue longs, as it were, for His lips. She bows Her lotus face and feigns great composure, yet even outwardly She is overwhelmed by the ecstatic transformations rising within Her.” (Rūpa Gosvāmī)

261 From this I know that there is some *rasa* in Me that subdues Rādhā, who enchants Me.

262 I am always eager to taste the kind of happiness Rādhā receives from Me.

263 I make many efforts, yet I cannot taste it. The mere fragrance of the sweetness of that happiness makes the longing in My heart grow.

264 It is to taste *rasa* that I descend, and I shall taste the *rasa* of love in all its many forms.

265 And through My own pastimes and conduct I shall teach how devotees practice devotion on the path of spontaneous love (*rāga-mārga*).

266 These three longings of Mine have not been fulfilled, for they cannot be tasted in a mood of a different kind.

267 Unless I accept Rādhikā's mood and luster, I can never taste those three kinds of happiness.

268 Accepting Rādhā's mood and assuming Her complexion, I shall descend to taste these three kinds of happiness.”

269 Thus Kṛṣṇa made His decision with all His heart. Just then the time came for the descent of the *yuga-avatāra*.

270 At that time Śrī Advaita was worshiping Kṛṣṇa, and His thunderous calls drew Kṛṣṇa down.

271–272 First He caused His father, mother and elders to descend. Then, accepting Rādhikā's mood and complexion, Kṛṣṇa appeared in Navadvīpa like the full moon rising from the pure milk-ocean of Śacī's womb.

273 Thus I have explained the sixth verse, meditating on the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī.

274 The meaning I have given to these two verses is supported by a verse of Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī:

275 “Playful by nature, He wished to take for Himself and enjoy the boundless, indescribably sweet wealth of *rasa* belonging to one among the host of His loving ones. So He covered His own complexion and revealed here Her radiance. May that Lord, who has appeared in the form of Caitanya, be abundantly merciful to us.” (Stava-mālā, Second Caitanyāṣṭaka 3)

276 The auspicious invocation, the characteristics of the truth of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, and the purpose of His descent have been set forth in six verses.

277 Ever hoping for the mercy of the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.